

CLASS 1 • MATHEMATICS

Taking Things Away!

Learning the Magic of Subtraction



The Hungry Little Monkey

A little monkey named Golu found a bunch of **5 sweet bananas** on a tree.

He was very hungry, so he ate **2 bananas** completely!

How many bananas are left hanging on the tree now?

and /

In simple words: When we remove some objects from a group, we are doing subtraction!

What is Subtraction?

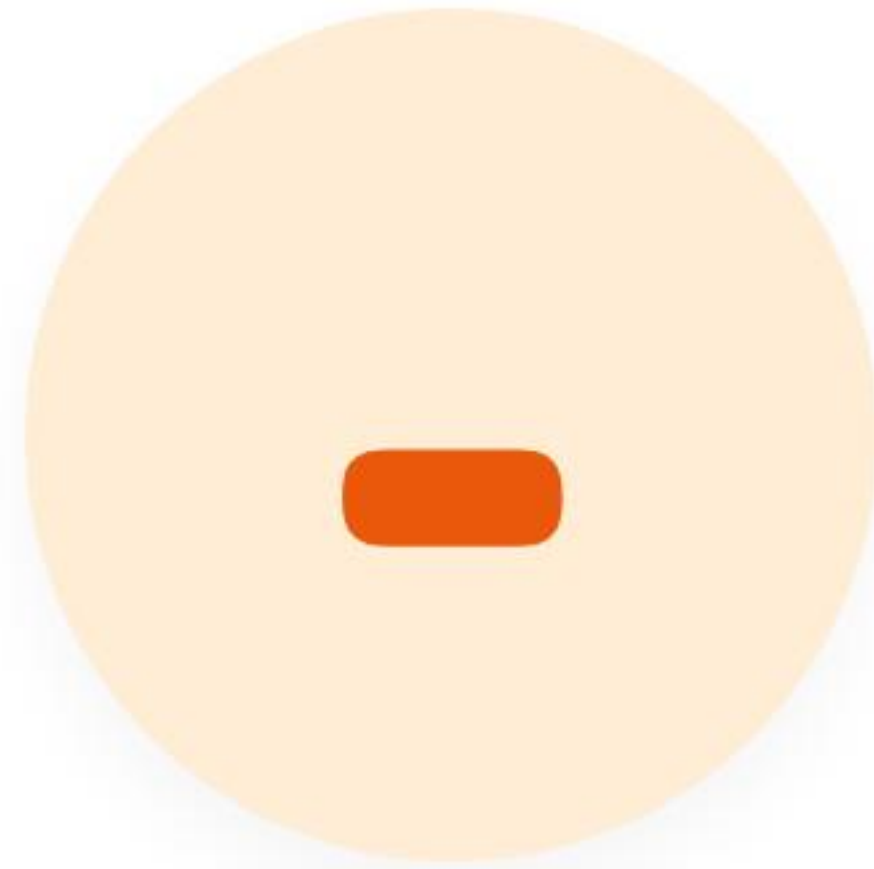


Subtraction means **taking away**, **losing**, or removing items from a collection.

Whenever we subtract, our final answer becomes **less** than what we started with!

In simple words: Subtraction is the math word for finding what is left over.

Meet the **Minus (-) Sign**



This simple straight horizontal line is named the **Minus sign**. It tells us to remove the second number from the first one!

In simple words: The "-" sign means "Take this many away!".

The **Equals (=)** Sign Reminder



Just like in addition, the **Equals sign** sits right before our final answer balance to show the results!

Our First Subtraction Sentence

Let's read a complete subtraction row sentence together out loud:

$$2 - 1 = 1$$

"Two minus One equals One!"

Frogs on a Water Lily Pad



3 Little Frogs

-



1 Jumps Away

3

-

1

=

2

Flying Sparrows



5 birds were sitting on a wall.
3 birds flew away into the sky.

$$5 - 3 = 2$$

Subtracting **Zero (0)**

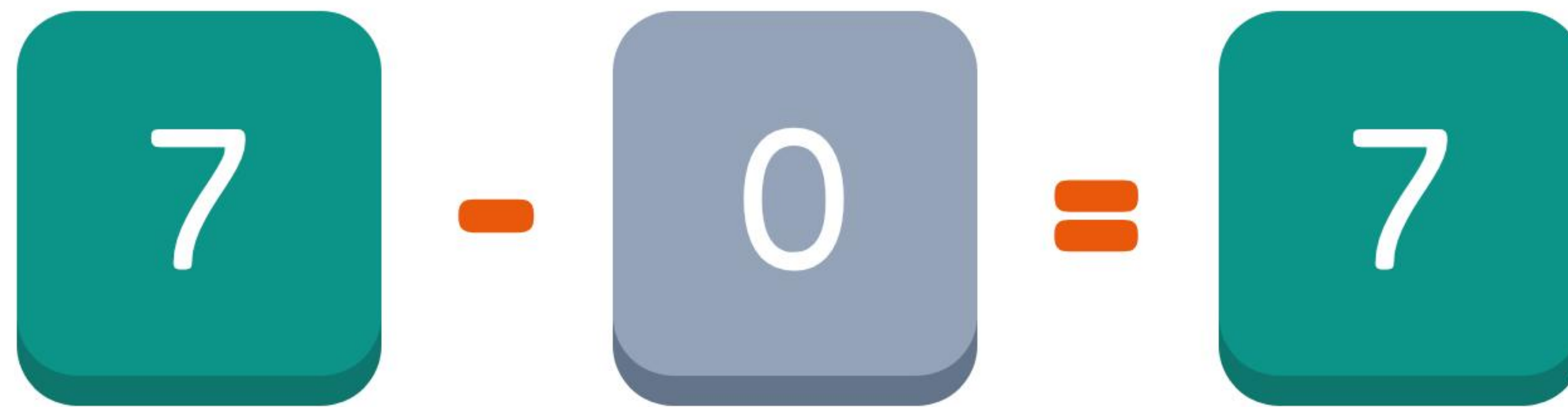
You have 4 juicy red apples. If you give away **zero** apples to your friend, how many do you have left?

Zero means nothing! So your apple basket stays completely full.

$$4 - 0 = 4$$

In simple words: Subtracting zero from any number changes absolutely nothing!

Zero Identity Check


$$7 - 0 = 7$$

7 toy cars minus 0 lost cars equals exactly 7 cars remaining!

Subtracting the Same Number

$$3 - 3 = 0$$

If you make 3 lovely clay toys and all 3 of them accidentally break, what are you left with?

You have 0 toys left!

In simple words: Subtracting a number from itself always leaves you with zero.

All Gone Practice


$$6 - 6 = 0$$

6 balloons are blown up. All 6 pop loudly!
Now there are 0 balloons remaining.

Subtraction Standing Up!

Just like with addition, we can stack subtraction numbers vertically like a tower blocks!

We read it down from top to bottom.
The final answer stays perfectly identical.

$$\begin{array}{r} 5 \\ - 2 \\ \hline 3 \end{array}$$

Vertical Block Practice

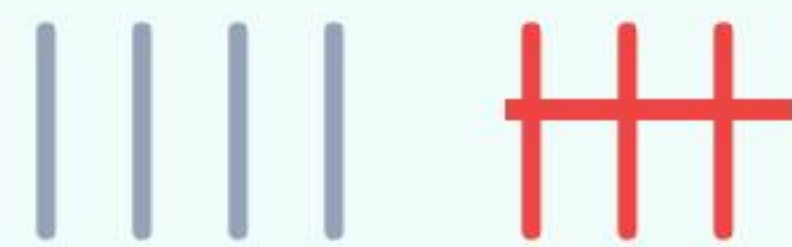
$$\begin{array}{r} 8 \\ - 4 \\ \hline 4 \end{array}$$

Open 8 fingers. Fold down 4 of them. Count the standing fingers: 4!

The Line-Crossing Trick

When numbers get big, you can draw lines and cross out the ones you remove:

To solve 7 - 3:



Count the clean standing lines left...

Clean Balance:

4!

Count the **Fresh Lemons**



Solve this puzzle:

6 yellow lemons on the counter plate.

2 lemons are squeezed to make fresh lemonade juice.

**Remaining = 4
Lemons!**

Subtraction Story Time!

Mina bought **9 colorful glass bangles** from a village market stall.

On her way home, **4 bangles** accidentally cracked and broke.

Let's help Mina calculate her safe unbroken bangles!

$$9 - 4 = 5$$

Walking **Backward** on Numbers

To solve $5 - 2$, stand on number 5 and take 2 big jumps **backward**!

0 .. 1 .. 2 .. 3 4 .. 5

In simple words: Moving backward means values get smaller because we are losing items!

Backward Jump Practice

Start at 4. Jump backward 1 single step.

Where do you land? **3!**

Who Has Fewer?

Rahul: 6 Candies



Amit: 4 Candies



How many fewer candies does Amit have? $6 - 4 = 2$ candies!

Lightning Mental Round!

Can you answer instantly?

$$4 - 2 = ?$$

Think of 4 chocolate squares. You eat 2 of them up completely.

2!

Lightning Round Two!

5!

What is the balance?

$$8 - 3 = ?$$

Hold up 8 fingers. Tuck away 3 fingers quickly. Count the remaining.

Tonight's Fun Button Experiment

 x 7

Gather 7 small shirt buttons or beans on a dinner plate.

Close your eyes, push 3 buttons far away to the side of the table surface.

Open your eyes and count the 4 buttons left right in front of you!



Subtraction Mastermind!

You have mastered how to take away items and calculate your balance correctly!

Syllab Mathematics Curriculum Series • Class 1